

MSYS2

Software Distribution and Building Platform for Windows

MSYS2 is a collection of tools and libraries providing you with an easy-to-use environment for building, installing and running native Windows software.

It consists of a command line terminal called [mintty](#), bash, version control systems like git and subversion, tools like tar and awk and even build systems like autotools, all based on a modified version of [Cygwin](#). Despite some of these central parts being based on Cygwin, the main focus of MSYS2 is to provide a build environment for native Windows software and the Cygwin-using parts are kept at a minimum. MSYS2 provides up-to-date native builds for GCC, mingw-w64, CPython, CMake, Meson, OpenSSL, FFmpeg, Rust, Ruby, just to name a few.

To provide easy installation of packages and a way to keep them updated it features a package management system called [Pacman](#), which should be familiar to Arch Linux users. It brings many powerful features such as dependency resolution and simple complete system upgrades, as well as straight-forward and reproducible package building. Our package repository contains [more than 3700 pre-built packages](#) ready to install.

For more details see '[What is MSYS2?](#)' which also compares MSYS2 to other software distributions and development environments like [Cygwin](#), [WSL](#), [Chocolatey](#), [Scoop](#), ... and '[Who Is Using MSYS2?](#)' to see which projects are using MSYS2 and what for.

Installation

1. Download the installer:

[↓ msys2-x86_64-20260611.exe](#)

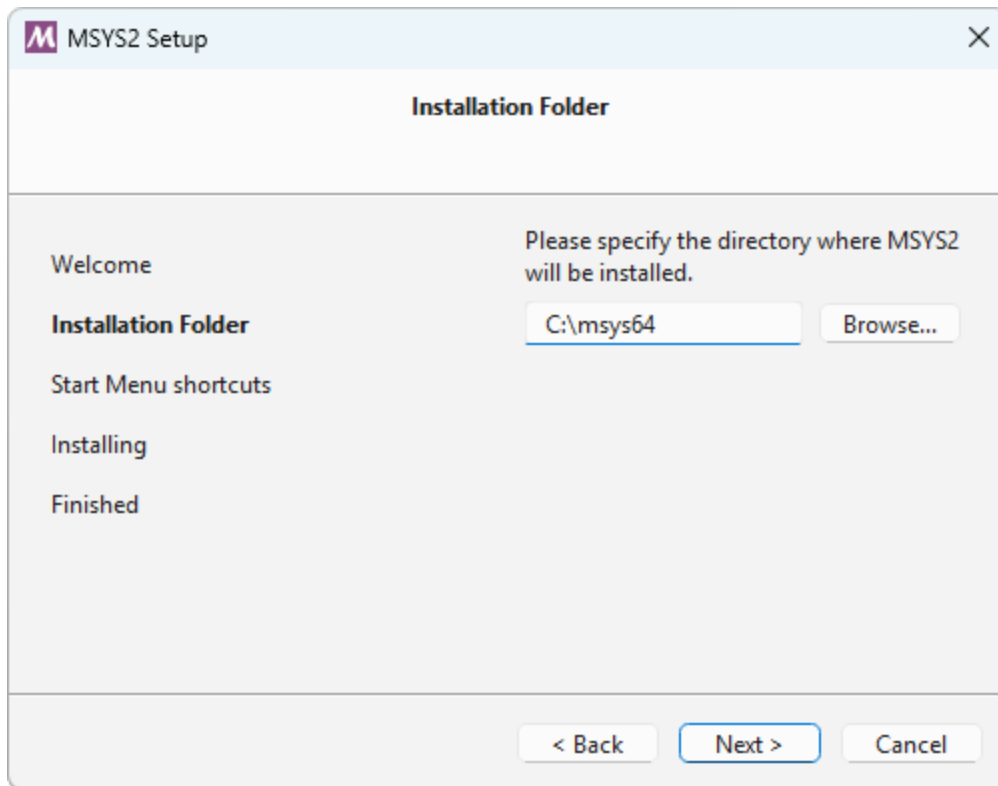
or

[↓ msys2-arm64-20260611.exe](#)

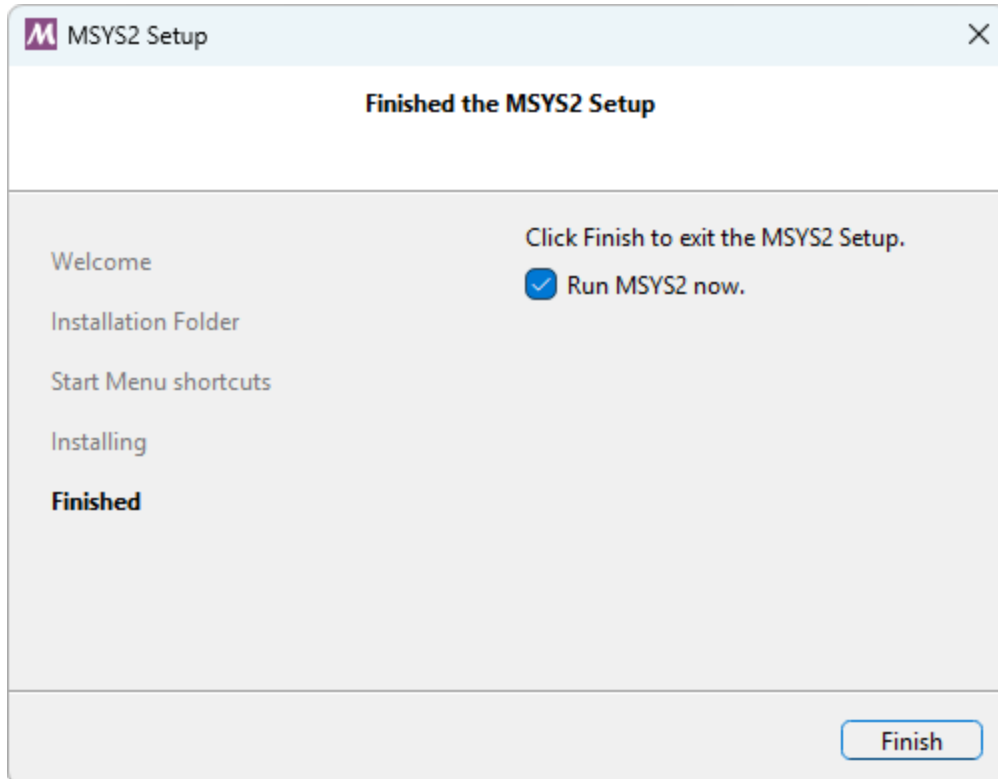
(ARM64)

(Optional) For more information on the installer, like command line options, or how to verify the checksum and signature of the installer, see the [installer guide](#).

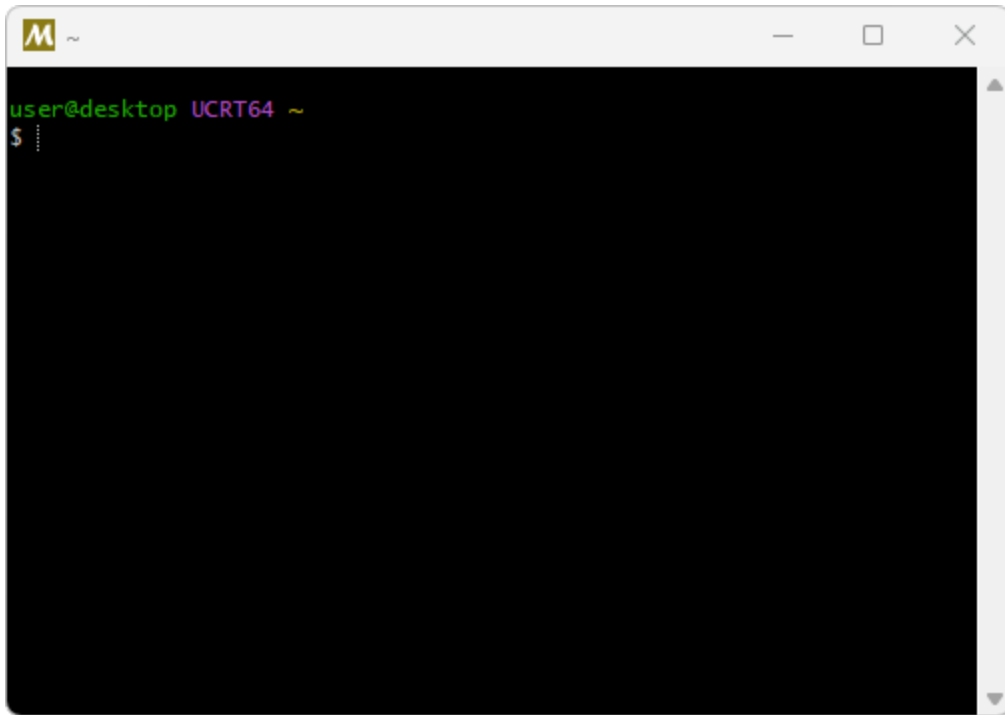
2. Run the installer. Installing MSYS2 requires 64 bit Windows 10 (1809+) or newer.
3. Enter your desired **Installation Folder**. We recommend using the default, see [installation folder recommendations](#) for more information.



4. When done, click **Finish**.



5. Now MSYS2 is ready for you and a terminal for the [UCRT64 environment](#) will launch.



6. You will probably want to install some tools like the mingw-w64 GCC to start compiling projects. Run the following command:

```
$ pacman -S mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-gcc
```

7. The terminal window will show the output as below. Press 'Enter' to continue:

```
resolving dependencies...
looking for conflicting packages...

Packages (17) mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-binutils-2.47-3
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-crt-14.0.0.r283.ga7cb47123-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-gcc-libs-16.2.0-3
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-gettext-runtime-1.0-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-gmp-6.3.0-2
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-headers-14.0.0.r283.ga7cb47123-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-isl-0.28-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-libiconv-1.19-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-libwinpthread-14.0.0.r283.ga7cb47123-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-mpc-1.4.1-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-mpfr-4.2.2-3
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-tzdata-2026c-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-windows-default-manifest-20260815-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-winpthread-14.0.0.r283.ga7cb47123-1
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-zlib-1.3.2-2
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-zstd-1.5.7-2
               mingw-w64-ucrt-x86_64-gcc-16.2.0-3
```

```
Total Download Size:    69.90 MiB
Total Installed Size:  487.51 MiB

:: Proceed with installation? [Y/n]
[... downloading and installation continues ...]
```

8. Now you can call `gcc` to build software for Windows.

```
$ gcc --version
gcc.exe (Rev3, Built by MSYS2 project) 16.2.0
```

9. After installing MSYS2 it will update itself via `pacman`, see the [update guide](#) for more information.

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